



Given the emerging opportunities, global firms are also planning to expand their presence in India. Global partnerships will play a crucial role in accessing tech, markets, investment opportunities, and talent. The space policy expected to be announced soon will provide the framework for private sector participation for domestic and foreign firms.

India can become the most connected country in the world. The multiple low-earth orbit constellations being planned will connect every nook and corner of the country digitally. And soon, we will have universal access to internet available at very affordable prices.

Focus on R&D and manufacturing of advanced materials, and on space-grade electronics is a must for attaining *Aatmanirbharta* (self-reliance) in the space sector. India has the potential to be the next space manufacturing hub for the world,

particularly for small satellites and space-grade components. Various state governments are already looking to set up dedicated plug and play space parks with attractive incentives.

Another area where India can emerge as the leader is launch services. With launch costs reducing drastically, India could become the most reliable partner for least-cost launches. However, a lot of work still needs to be done to achieve this goal. A whole-of-nation approach based on defined national priorities aligned with the Indian space policy, FDI policy and other regulations will be a must to ensure necessary institutional and policy support.

Disproportionate investment in capacities and capital-intensive tech will be required to develop high-end complex spacetechnology within India. Already, ISRO is going all out to help the private sector by giving access to

its ecosystem, including tech, infrastructure and expertise. Fully indigenous tech is being made available for the private players to scale and commercialise, such as the satellite design and fabrication technology of IMS-1 (a low-cost micro-satellite imaging mission of ISRO). Private sector must come forward to build in India for the world.

Developing complex spacetechnology requires massive investments. While, after the first demonstrable success of Indian start-ups, investments in the Indian space sector have gained momentum, there is still a long way to go before we see a 'SpaceX moment' in the Indian space start-up ecosystem. Investors need to gain more confidence in the Indian space start-up ecosystem. At the same time, Indian start-ups need to communicate their story well to attract investments. The revised FDI policy is also expected to facilitate FDI into Indian space start-ups.

Additionally, India Inc. will need to work on the competitiveness of its offerings/solutions and play its marketing game well. We have world-class solutions to offer and we need to market them strategically.

To enable the Indian space ecosystem as outlined above, the government has set up IN-SPACe as an autonomous body under the Department of Space to orchestrate the transition to a new space era. Both IN-SPACe and ISRO have been working closely to support the private sector and boost the private Indian space economy.

The world around us is moving fast and we need to keep pace with it. There is a huge opportunity in the sector and India Inc. must pull up its socks to make the most of it. We need to dream big, and dream as if even the sky is not the limit anymore! **BT**

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